

Colin Heeneman

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Portfolio: colin-heeneman.github.io

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Chicago

Master of Public Policy

Specialization in Public Health Policy · GPA: 3.93/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Data Analysis, Policy Analysis, Program Design and Evaluation, Public Administration

Chicago, IL

Dec 2022 – Dec 2024

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Bachelor of Political Science

Concentration in Public Policy and Democratic Institutions · GPA: 3.6/4.0

Relevant Coursework: Intro to Public Policy, Political Theory, Public Policy Development

Urbana, IL

Aug 2018 – May 2022

WORK EXPERIENCE

Nathalie P. Voorhees Center for Neighborhood and Community Improvement

Research Assistant

Chicago, IL

June 2023 – Present

- Support the ADA-PARC project, a national research effort examining quality-of-life disparities for the disabled population across all 50 states and hundreds of geographic units.
 - Built scorecard dashboards natively in R and Quarto to visualize outcome disparities between disabled and non-disabled populations nationwide.
 - Built interactive website for geographic data display using R Shiny.
 - Developed a Descriptive Analysis Report based on 2023 ACS 5-year estimate outcomes.
- Support the City of Chicago 2025 Point-in-Time (PIT) Count, a federally mandated, citywide survey identifying 7,452 people experiencing homelessness, co-led by the Voorhees Center and DFSS.
 - Contributed to data cleaning, analysis, and production of visualizations for the published 2025 PIT Count & Survey Report.

Jefferson Educational Society

Research Intern

Erie, PA

May 2022 – November 2022

- Produced and edited publications while assisting with research projects and programming for Erie's local political think tank.
 - Published research analysis on Human Rights in Qatar.
 - Assisted the Jefferson team in facilitating the nationally recognized Global Summit.

SELECTED PROJECTS & RESEARCH

Medicaid Expansion & Health Insurance Coverage

Staggered difference-in-differences (Callaway-Sant'Anna) analysis of ACA Medicaid expansion using ACS and BRFSS panel data (2010 – 2019). Found a 2.3 percentage point reduction in the uninsured rate among non-elderly adults (95% CI: -3.5 to -1.1 pp), with a 5.1 pp reduction among adults below 200% FPL. Includes an accompanying policy brief for state-level decision-makers.

ADA-PARC Project

Descriptive and index-based analysis of quality-of-life disparities between disabled and non-disabled populations using 2023 ACS 5-year data across all 50 states and hundreds of geographies. Delivered via written report, an R Shiny application, and scorecard dashboards built natively in R and Quarto.

WIC Program Evaluation

Regression discontinuity design estimating the effect of WIC income-eligibility (185% FPL) on infant birth weight, using synthetic data to demonstrate the evaluation framework under realistic data constraints. With Emily Frost and Samantha Sepulveda, UIC PA 528.

RESEARCH METHODS

- Staggered Difference-in-Differences (Callaway-Sant'Anna)
- Regression Discontinuity Design
- Multivariate Regression & Fixed Effects
- Survey-Weighted Estimation
- Descriptive & Index-Based Analysis
- Program Logic Models & Evaluation Design

SKILLS

- Policy Analysis & Memo Writing
- Program Evaluation
- Written & Verbal Communication
- Stakeholder Engagement

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Reproducible Research Pipeline: R, Quarto, renv, and Git/GitHub for version-controlled, dependency-locked analysis from raw data through published report.

Additional Software: R Shiny, LaTeX, Notion, Obsidian, Adobe Acrobat, Microsoft 365, Apple Ecosystem

ADDITIONAL

President of Active Minds UIUC (2021 – 2022): Led student advocacy organization for mental health awareness; lobbied the counseling center to expand resources for students, succeeding in printing the suicide prevention hotline on all student I.D. cards.